



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Imago Dei Academy

School Website: <https://imagodeiacademywi.com/>

December 30, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) or the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Imago Dei Academy (IDA) in Ladysmith, Wisconsin presents a mainly classical, Christian program that aligns strongly with the core six elements of classical education. The school identifies itself explicitly as classical and Christian, with ongoing affiliation to ACCS and CLSA, and anchors its curriculum in Memoria Press and Highlands Latin School frameworks. Public materials emphasize the Liberal Arts, Great Books, Latin/Greek study, and a liturgical, chapel-centered culture, including explicit Christian worship and Bible-centered pedagogy. Evidence shows a coherent integration of theology, foundational classical aims (virtue, wisdom, truth), history-centered curriculum, and a pedagogy that includes memory work, recitation, and liturgical practices. Parents are positioned as partners in formation, and the faculty emphasize living curriculum and mentorship. The aggregate assessment is CLASSICAL across all six categories, with ample textual grounding in the school's materials.

Key insights: - Religious and metaphysical foundations are explicit (Christian worldview, chapel, liturgy, Imago Dei). - Purpose/goals are oriented toward virtue, wisdom, and formation (not just workforce prep). - Curriculum emphasizes liberal arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Great Books, Latin/Greek, and Western history. - Pedagogy leans toward memory, recitation, and a liturgical/educational rhythm; some evidence of Socratic elements is indirect but the rhetoric/logic emphasis is clear. - Faculty materials present teachers as living exemplars and mentors; "teacher as living curriculum" is reinforced in materials. - Parent/community partnership is foregrounded (open houses, tours, parent involvement, connection through newsletters, and family engagement).

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - IDA presents itself as a Classical Christian school with a Christian worldview, chapels, and Bible-centered worship; mentions of liturgical elements and church-based collaboration are evident in multiple public materials.

- Public materials describe classical education as the cultivation of wisdom and virtue, with Christian culture and Biblical worldview as a core aim. - Chapel services with pledges to flags and the Bible, including singing and a sermonette, demonstrate liturgical and communal practice.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Imago Dei; Classical; Christian; chapel; liturgy/worship; Holy Bible; sermonette; virtue; wisdom; truth (implied through Christian teaching); theology (through Christian worldview); Great Books (via classical framework); Memoria Press (curriculum lineage). - Negative keywords: none clearly evident (no explicit relativism, secular humanism, or "morally neutral" language detected in public postings).

Why this rating - The school's public materials center Christian metaphysical commitments, liturgical practices, and a theologically informed pedagogy, aligning strongly with the Positive indicators for the Religious and Metaphysical Foundations category and lacking countervailing negative signals.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The goal is described as forming wise and virtuous students, with Christian formation; the Great Books and Christian worldview are positioned as central to ongoing formation. - The school emphasizes formation and the cultivation of virtue and wisdom, rooted in classical education's aims (not merely job preparation).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: formation; virtue; wisdom; true/good/beautiful (integrated via Great Books and Christian worldview); liberal arts; classical mission. - Negative keywords: none clearly evident (no emphasis on "college readiness" or workforce-prep language that would signal a shift away from formation).

Why this rating - IDA's stated aims center formation, virtue, wisdom, and a classical mission, with explicit reference to truth/beauty/good as real and knowable through Christian classical education, yielding a CLASSICAL rating.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Curriculum emphasizes liberal arts: grammar, logic, rhetoric, with explicit Great Books framing and a strong emphasis on Latin/Greek study (Latin is taught from early grades; upper grades include Latin translation and Greek studies). - History is treated as history within the classical canon (Western civilization, classical studies, Greek/Roman history), rather than simply "social studies." Examples include medieval and ancient history as part of the core curriculum. - Great Books and the Great Conversation are referenced as central to education; Memoria Press is used as a curriculum backbone; Latin/Greek studies are part of the core.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: liberal arts; grammar; logic; rhetoric; great books; classical studies; Latin; Greek; history; Western civilization; Bible literacy; music; art; liturgy (via curricular integration). - Negative keywords: none clearly evident (no "social studies" replacement of history; no "project-based learning dominance" language observed in public postings).

Why this rating - The curriculum content aligns with the Classical School lexicon: Trivium/quadrivium framing via grammar/logic/rhetoric; extensive Great Books approach; Latin/Greek instruction; historical study within Western civilization; and a literature/art/music component, all signaling CLASSICAL alignment.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Pedagogy includes contemplative/restful elements (scholastic-like cadence) as part of classical pedagogy; lower grades feature singing/chanting to deepen memory and delight; and upper grades emphasize logic, rhetoric, and opportunities for oral expression (speeches, debates, and rhetoric training). The public materials explicitly describe singing, memory, and liturgical/prayer-centered components in the lower grades and a higher emphasis on rhetoric in the upper grades. - The upper school curriculum includes logic and rhetoric as part of English credits, indicating a movement toward formal rhetorical training. - There are clearly liturgical and memory-based elements (chant/sacred music; prayer; catechesis) in daily practice.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: scholastic (implied by contemplative rhythm), memory work, recitation/narration, chanting, liturgy, seminar/colloquy (through emphasis on rhetoric and structured discussion); memory-based and liturgical calendar integration (from the lexicon and site). Privately available notes show emphasis on singing and prayer in lower grades; rhetoric and logic in higher grades.

- Negative keywords present: minimal explicit mention of experiential-only or project-based learning as the sole method; the site does not emphasize student-directed, constructivist approaches as the sole method. However, explicit Socratic seminar language is not strongly present in public postings, which reduces the strength of a full Socratic pedagogy signal.

Why this rating - The school clearly embeds classical pedagogical patterns (memory, recitation, chant; liturgical/communal practices; logic/rhetoric emphasis) but the explicit, heavy emphasis on Socratic seminars or continuous deliberative dialogue (a hallmark of high-school classical pedagogy) is present in less direct form. This yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL classification: grounded in classical methods with strong memory/chant/liturgical elements and strong logic/rhetoric, but less explicit Socratic/seminar emphasis in public-facing content.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials describe teachers as mentors who live the curriculum and model virtue; there are explicit references to teacher involvement in the “Living Curriculum” and to teacher leadership (e.g., “TEACHER’S CORNER” with named teachers). The presence of a teacher-centered, virtue-formation narrative and explicit teacher showcases (e.g., “Mrs. Sitler, Choir Teacher”; “Mrs. Rapp, Lower Grammar Teacher”) indicate a teacher-as-model and teacher-as core (not mere facilitators). - There is emphasis on teacher professional alignment with classical pedagogy (Memoria Press training notes; Highlands Latin School mentorship) and a sense of teachers as spiritual exemplars and mentors. - The school presents a structured, “living curriculum” and portraits of ideal teacher-student relationships (from the public-facing “Teacher’s Corner” materials).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: living curriculum; portrait of a teacher; teachers as mentors; teacher as core of the school; teacher training in classical pedagogy; collegial culture; moral exemplars. - Negative keywords present: none evident (no “facilitator” or “guide on the side” trope appears in the public text).

Why this rating - The public materials emphasize teachers as the central, virtuous, mentor-based core of the school with explicit professional alignment to classical pedagogy, yielding a CLASSICAL rating for Element 5.

Element 6: School Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school foregrounds partnership with parents and presents opportunities for parent involvement (open houses, tours, admissions interviews; parent events; newsletters; and “Connect” page inviting parental engagement). □filecite□turn0file3□turn0file7□ - Public materials describe parent formation and classical book clubs/book-study style opportunities and family engagement (parent/teacher conferences; family-based activities; newsletters). - The school’s communications indicate an open-campus philosophy and frequent parental access (calendar items, open houses, and communications that welcome parent involvement).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with parents; co-teachers; parental formation; open campus; parent covenant; family liturgy; home catechesis; parent involvement; open visits; gatherings; newsletters and book clubs as means of parent formation. - Negative keywords present: none clearly evident (no consumer/customer language; the site emphasizes active parental involvement rather than passive consumption).

Why this rating - The site consistently presents parents as co-educators and partners, with explicit calls for family engagement, open visits, and parent formation, aligning with CLASSICAL indicators for parent/community involvement.

Aggregate Classification - Element 1: CLASSICAL - Element 2: CLASSICAL - Element 3: CLASSICAL - Element 4: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL - Element 5: CLASSICAL - Element 6: CLASSICAL

Overall: CLASSICAL

What Would Move the Needle - If aiming for a full CLASSICAL standard in Pedagogy, the school could further articulate and publicly demonstrate explicit Socratic seminars and formal seminar structures in upper grades. Additional public-facing description of seminar protocols, dialectic methods, and Paideia-style instruction would solidify the Pedagogy signal as fully CLASSICAL.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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